

Ladybird spider In many spider species, the males are much smaller than the females, but ladybird spiders have different colors too. The male has a bright red, spotted body, while the female is jet black.



Wrapped in silk

The female lays her eggs on a mat of silk and covers them with more threads. Then she molds the silky mass into a ball-shaped egg sac and attaches it to a nearby surface.

The female watches over her eggs for as long as she can. She will die when it gets colder.

See also

Read about the king cobra (104–105), who is a venomous mom too—and also guards her eggs.

Tiny spiderlings

Between 300 and 1,400 baby spiders (spiderlings) hatch from the eggs in the sac. In cooler climates, spiderlings that hatch in fall stay in the sac until spring so they don't freeze to death.

Roaming far away

Some spiderlings remain nearby. Others spin a strand of silk that gets caught by the breeze and carries them to new places, where there is hopefully less competition for food and mates. This is called ballooning.

Scorpion Baby scorpions are vulnerable because they have soft exoskeletons. They ride on their mother's back for safety until their exoskeletons harden. Then they dismount and begin life on their own.

